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An Online Learning Study About Staying Safe Online

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET

(1) What is this study about?

You are invited to take part in a research study about You are invited to take part in a research study about an online learning platform that provides information on common online risks and how to stay safe when using the internet. You have been invited to participate in this study because You have been invited to participate in this study because you are aged 50 or over and your feedback will help evaluate how clear, useful, and accessible the learning platform is for adults in this age group. This Participant Information Sheet tells you about the research study. Knowing what is involved will help you decide if you want to take part in the study. Please read this sheet carefully and ask questions about anything that you don't understand or want to know more about.

Participation in this research study is voluntary. By giving consent to take part in this study you are telling us that you:

- ✓ Understand what you have read.
- ✓ Agree to take part in the research study as outlined below.
- ✓ Agree to the use of your personal information as described.
- ✓ You have received a copy of this Participant Information Sheet to keep.

(2) Who is running the study?

The study is being carried out by the following student - Mr Oscar Turner - who is conducting this study as the basis for the degree of Business Information Systems at the University of East Anglia.

This will take place under the supervision of Dr Riaz Ahmed Shaikh (Riaz-Ahmed.Shaikh@uea.ac.uk,).

(3) What will the study involve for me?

Participation will take place online at a location chosen by the participant and at a time convenient to them. Involvement will consist of a single session lasting approximately 30–40 minutes.

Participants will access an online learning platform via a link provided by email. They will first read participant information and provide consent, then engage with the learning content, complete a short test based on the information provided, and finally complete an anonymous online questionnaire about their experience.

No access to personal information, records, or identifiable data will be requested or used as part of this study.

You will not have the opportunity to review information generated about you prior to publication.

(4) How much of my time will the study take?

Participation will involve a single online session lasting approximately 30–40 minutes in total. This includes around 20–25 minutes engaging with the learning platform content, approximately 5–10 minutes completing the short test, and a further 5 minutes completing the anonymous online questionnaire. Participation takes place at a time and location chosen by the participant.

(5) Do I have to be in the study? Can I withdraw from the study once I have started?

Being in this study is completely voluntary and you do not have to take part.

Your decision whether to participate will not affect your current or future relationship with the researchers or anyone else at the University of East Anglia now or in the future.

If you decide to take part in the study, you can withdraw your consent at any point. You can do this by You can do this by choosing not to continue with the study at any point, closing the browser window, or not submitting the questionnaire. As the questionnaire is anonymous, once responses have been submitted they cannot be withdrawn.

(6) What are the consequences if I withdraw from the study?

If you decide to take part in the study and then change your mind, you are free to withdraw at any time before you have submitted the questionnaire. Once you have submitted it, your responses cannot be withdrawn because they are anonymous and therefore we will not be able to tell which one is yours.

(7) Are there any risks or costs associated with being in the study?

Aside from giving up your time, we do not expect that there will be any risks or costs associated with taking part in this study.

(8) Are there any benefits associated with being in the study?

Participants may benefit from increased awareness and understanding of common online risks and social engineering techniques, which may help them feel more confident and informed when using the internet. The findings from this study may help inform the development of accessible educational resources aimed at improving online safety awareness for older adults, with potential benefits for wider communities.

(9) What will happen to information provided by me and data collected during the study?

No personal data will be collected as part of this study. The information you provide will be submitted anonymously through an online questionnaire and stored securely within Microsoft Forms. Your responses will be used only for the purposes of this research project and academic assessment. The data will be kept securely for a limited period and permanently deleted once it is no longer required.

Your personal data and information will only be used as outlined in this Participant Information Sheet, unless you consent otherwise. Data management will follow the Data Protection Act 2018 (DPA 2018) and UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR), and the University of East Anglia's [Research Data Management Policy](#).

The information you provide will be stored securely and your identity will be kept strictly confidential, except as required by law. Study findings will be used for the purposes of my dissertation and may also be used for other scholarly and educational purposes such as research publications and in teaching, but you will not be identified if you decide to participate in this study. Where the study findings are solely used for the dissertation, the data will be destroyed following the examination of the dissertation. Where the study findings will also be used for other purposes such as publications, the data will be kept for at least 10 years beyond the last date the data were used. The study findings may be deposited in a repository to allow it to facilitate its reuse. The deposited data will not include your name or any identifiable information about you.

No additional information is required, as no personal or identifiable data will be collected.

(10) What if I would like further information about the study?

When you have read this information, Mr Oscar Turner (vfs22aqu@uea.ac.uk, 07956846830) will be available to discuss it with you further and answer any questions you may have.

(11) Will I be told the results of the study?

You are not able to receive feedback about the overall results.

(12) What if I have a complaint or any concerns about the study?

If there is a problem please let me know. You can contact me via the University of East Anglia at the following address:

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NORWICH NR4 7TJ
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07956846830

If you would like to speak to someone else you can contact my supervisor: Dr Riaz Ahmed Shaikh (Riaz-Ahmed.Shaikh@uea.ac.uk,). If you are concerned about the way this study is being conducted or you wish to make a complaint to someone independent from the study, please contact the Head of School of Computing Sciences: Head of School of Computing Sciences (cmp@uea.ac.uk, +44 (0)1603 592900).

(13) How do I know that this study has been approved to take place?

To protect your safety, rights, wellbeing and dignity, all research in the University of East Anglia is reviewed by a Research Ethics Body. This research was approved by the SCI S-REC (Faculty of Science Research Ethics Subcommittee).

(14) What is the general data protection information I need to be informed about?

According to data protection legislation, we are required to inform you that the legal basis for processing your data as listed in Article 6(1) of the UK GDPR is because this allows us to process personal data when it is necessary to perform our public tasks as a University.

In addition to the specific information provided above about why your personal data is required and how it will be used, there is also some general information which needs to be provided for you:

- The data controller is the University of East Anglia.
- For further information, you can contact the University's Data Protection Officer at dataprotection@uea.ac.uk
- You can also find out more about your data protection rights at the [Information Commissioner's Office \(ICO\)](#).
- If you are unhappy with how your personal data has been used, please contact the University's Data Protection Officer at dataprotection@uea.ac.uk in the first instance.

(15) OK, I want to take part – what do I do next?

If you are happy and consent to take part in the study simply access the questionnaire at this website <https://forms.office.com/Pages/ResponsePage.aspx?id=lydfxj26UUOKBwhl5djwkMnRfGEL0MVEiD6sTTWRqJtURU1GUjVMSDY2SDNVUU9LWE5TVzIFRNBTC4u> and answer the questions. By submitting your responses you are agreeing to the researcher using the data collected for the purposes described above. Please keep the information sheet for your information.

(16) Further information

This information was last updated on 20 April 2026.

If there are changes to the information provided, you will be notified by If there are changes to the information provided, you will be notified via the study webpage before taking part.

This information sheet is for you to keep